

Midpoints

Enigma Factsheet · Midpoints

A midpoint is the point that — measured along the ecliptic — lies exactly halfway between two other points in the horoscope. An example: Jupiter is at 11°30' Taurus and Saturn at 15°00' Cancer. The distance between the two planets is 63°30'. The midpoint lies at half that distance, so 31°45' from both Jupiter and Saturn. That corresponds to 13°15' Gemini.

Each midpoint effectively forms an axis: the point in Gemini and the opposite point in Sagittarius are both midpoints of Jupiter and Saturn. Which of the two you consider the "primary" midpoint depends on the shortest arc between the two planets.

★ ★ ★

Calculation

To calculate a midpoint, you first convert the positions to degrees from 0° Aries. Then you add both values and divide the result by two.

For the above example:

Jupiter	11°30'	Taurus	=	41°30'
Saturn	15°00'	Cancer	=	105°00'

Sum				146°30'
Divided by two:				73°15'
In signs and degrees:				13°15' Gemini

★ ★ ★

Direct and Indirect Midpoints

A planet activates a midpoint not only when it is exactly conjunct or opposite. Planets forming a quarter- or eighth-circle aspect with the midpoint are also considered relevant. Occasionally the sixteenth-circle aspect is used as well. This yields the following aspects:

DIVISION OF THE CIRCLE	ANGLE
4	90°
8	45°
16	22°30'

Enigma supports division by 4 and 8.

A conjunction or opposition on the midpoint is called a **direct midpoint**. An activation via one of the above aspects is called an **indirect midpoint**.

For the orb — the allowed deviation — most astrologers use a margin of 1°36'. Some schools work with a stricter orb of 1°.

★ ★ ★

Planetary Pictures and Midpoint Structures

One or more other points may be placed on the axis of a midpoint. If the Moon is at 14°15' Gemini, it forms a conjunction with the midpoint of Jupiter and Saturn calculated above. This is written as:

Moon = Jupiter / Saturn

or conversely: **Jupiter / Saturn = Moon**

The interpretation of such combinations can be found in the standard works, see bibliography, but you can of course also interpret them yourself based on planetary meanings.

A planet can simultaneously be on multiple midpoints. If the Moon is on both the midpoint of Jupiter/Saturn and the midpoint of Mercury/Mars, this is shown in what is called a **planetary picture** (Uranian Astrology) or **midpoint structure** (Ebertin/Cosmobiology). See also the section *History*.

★ ★ ★

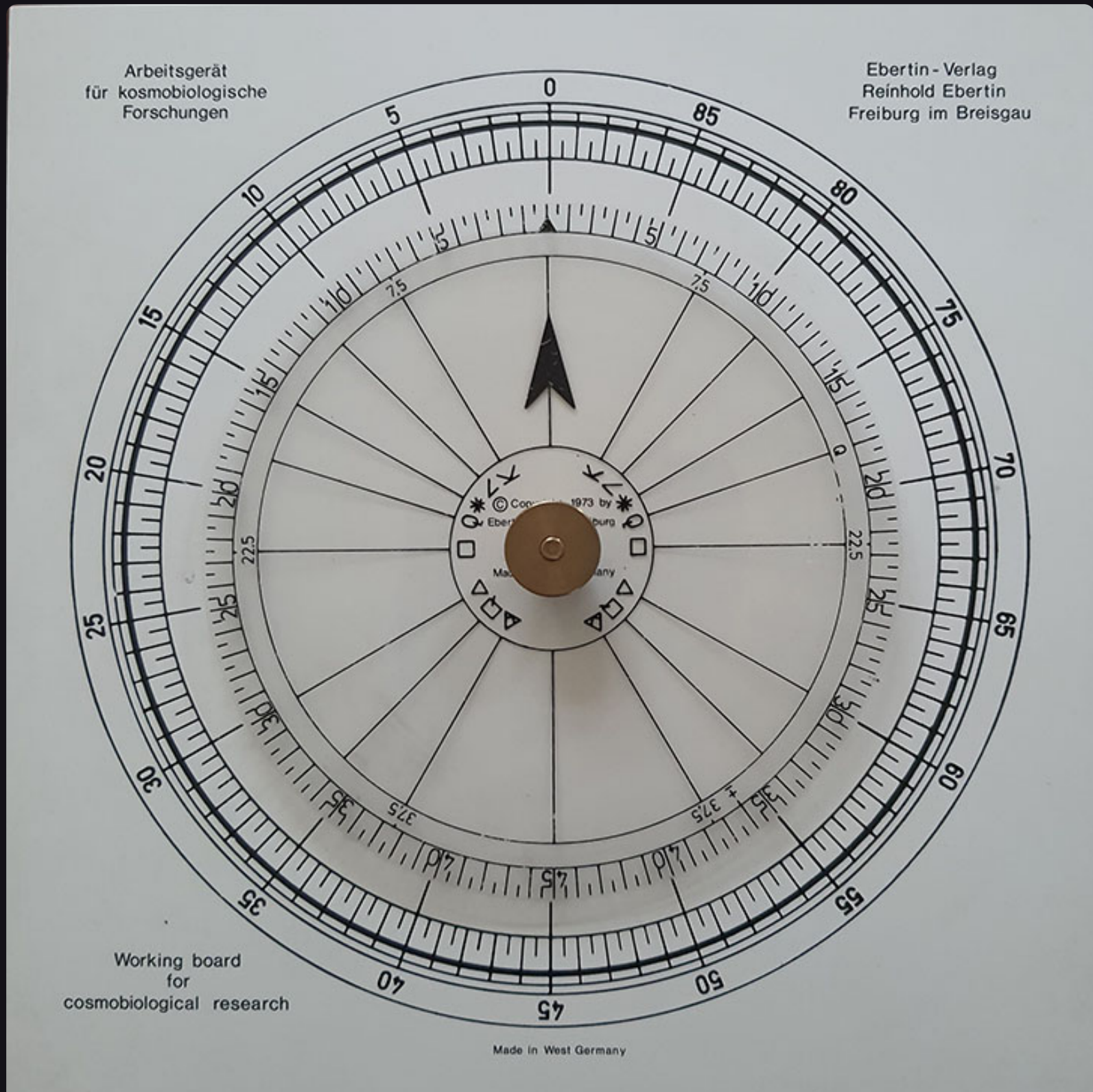
The 90° and 45° Dial

Because all relevant aspects to midpoints are divisions of 360° by a power of two, it is possible to "fold" the horoscope into a smaller circle. On a 90° dial, all points that are in conjunction, opposition, or square with each other coincide. On a 45° dial, this also applies to points in a semisquare (45°) or sesquisquare (135°).

This makes it visually much easier to identify midpoint activations than in the regular 360° horoscope. In the past, astrologers used manual calculation dials for this purpose, see images below; modern software generates these dials automatically.



The 360-degree dial of Uranian astrology.



The 90-degree dial of Ebertin.

★ ★ ★

Half-sums

A common alternative name for midpoint is **half-sum**: the sum of two planetary longitudes divided by two. This term is still common in German-language texts (*Halbsumme*). In English-language work one generally speaks of *midpoints*.

★ ★ ★

History

The systematic use of midpoints in astrology is attributed to the German astrologer **Alfred Witte**, who introduced the concept around 1919.

Witte was the founder of **Die Hamburger Schule**, known in English as *Uranian Astrology*. His method was later developed by Ludwig Rudolph, Friedrich Sieggriin, and Hermann Lefeldt.

The German astrologer **Reinhold Ebertin** adopted the idea and popularised it under the name **Cosmobiology**. Ebertin simplified the method and placed greater emphasis on psychological interpretation. Both currents were active throughout the twentieth century and have had a lasting influence on the modern use of midpoints.

★ ★ ★

Bibliography

- Witte, Alfred; Rudolph, Ludwig; Sieggriin, Friedrich; Lefeldt, Hermann - *Regelwerk für Planetenbilder*. Hamburg, 1959.
- Rudolph, Ludwig, Witte, Alfred, Lefeldt, Herman - *Alfred Witte's Rules for Planetary Pictures: The Astrology of Tomorrow*. Hamburg, Hamburg 1959.
- Ebertin, Reinhold - *Kombination der Gestirneinflüsse*. Aalen, 1974. English translation: *Combination of Stellar Influences*.
- Simms, Maria Kay - *Dial detective. Investigation with the 90° dial*. San Diego, CA, 1989.